

## BlackBerry Bold 9790

A new video that gives a tutorial on the yet to be released BlackBerry Bold 9790 is doing the rounds of the net: <http://goo.gl/K8RMI>

## Now read emotions!

MIT's media lab has developed spectacles tell you what the person in front of you is feeling via an in-built emotion recognition software.

DIY

### Cabinet woes

Since we're looking at a compact system, it is pertinent to keep a tab on the dimensions and expansion slots offered. You'll come across plenty of sleek-looking cabinets, but these are the questions you need to ask yourself.

- Will it fit the motherboard comfortably? (Look at specs such as the form factor - ITX, Mini-ITX. But it's best if you could actually place the board and see for yourself.)
- Will there be enough space for managing the wires?
- Is there space for adding a discrete card?
- Is the cabinet well ventilated?

### Avoid overclocking

It makes no sense to overclock the processor you're using in an HTPC rig for the simple fact that overclocking will generate more heat and may cause the rig to overheat. The whole idea of an HTPC is to have a low power, cool and quiet system beside your HDTV. Overclocking will ruin that notion. Period.

### Media player user interfaces

The Xbox Media Centre and Boxee, both are open source media players and entertainment hubs for all your digital media. Both work on any and every platform that you can think of. The installation is quite simple and the interface is aesthetically pleasing. If you're planning a dedicated HTPC then you can download the Windows or Linux version from [http://bit.ly/digit\\_htpc1](http://bit.ly/digit_htpc1) (XBMC) or [http://bit.ly/digit\\_htpc3](http://bit.ly/digit_htpc3) (Boxee). The Linux version can be installed in a flash drive using the popular utility Unetbootin ([http://bit.ly/digit\\_htpc2](http://bit.ly/digit_htpc2)) and the system can be booted from it. So, no other operating is required!

There are many skins and utilities available. The audio quality is decent and dependent on your audio device. It is distortion-free but offers no equalisation options or advanced audio options. A major functionality that both of them lack is PVR support.

### Media players and codecs

So you've assembled your rig but your Blu-ray 1080p rip won't play as it is in the MKV format. Ensure you have the right

media player and all the codecs required to playback those files. We prefer the free VLC Media Player and Windows Media Player Classic. Also download K-Lite Mega Codec Pack, available for free on the net or better still, get it on our DVD.

### Invest in a wireless keyboard/mouse combo

You surely don't want to see wires coming out from under your TV to your keyboard and mouse. Invest in a good wireless keyboard with a trackball. You'll get one, starting at around ₹2,000. Although this increases the overall cost by a bit, especially when compared to wired options are available, the reduction in wiring and the associated clutter is heartening!

### Before you start

1. Work in a cool environment to avoid damaging any computer parts with wet hands.
2. Be careful not to drop any small parts (particularly screws) into unreachable areas such as into the computer fan or disk drive.
3. Before touching any part within the tower, put your hands against another metal surface (such as the computer casing) or just stand barefoot on the ground to remove static charge, which may damage sensitive devices.
4. A container or piece of paper with labels for each part (casing, motherboard, CD drive, etc) is ideal to avoid confusion between the similar-looking screws. We use labelled paper cups to store screws.
5. Handle all parts with care. Place each piece you remove carefully down onto a stable surface.
6. Don't forcefully remove components. Instead, check that you're removing them correctly and no wires are in the way.
7. Be careful when holding the motherboard, it's underside is actually quite pointy and can scratch you.
8. Never attempt to remove the power source, while its still connected to the power supply.
9. When removing any cables, wires or ribbons, grasp the wire at the base or head to keep it from breaking.

### STEPS



Make a checklist so that you have everything in one place to keep at bay the "what goes where" problem. Seen in the picture above are the following components: A Cooler Master Elite 100 Cabinet, 2 x 2GB Corsair Dominator DDR3 RAM, WD 300GB Velociraptor HDD, SATA cables, Stock Intel cooler, Intel Core i5-2500 processor, ZOTAC Z68ITX AE board and a screwdriver along with a paper cup to hold all the screws.



Unscrew the cabinet screws and take off the cover. Many HTPC cabinets (such as ours) have the power supply already installed, so if you need more space to work with, remove that (like we did)



Remove the top flap of the cabinet. As you can see, it comes with a power supply.



We also removed the front panel so that the HDD holding panel could come off and we could install the hard disk easily.